

LittleReads

Amara and the Talking Baobab

African Stories

Ages 6–8

by LittleReads Editorial Team

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The village of Olet Cove, the special Tabby said it had with the Boo body
one made a white peak as plenty of long time was wide enough for five
children to hold hands around, and its branches stretched out like great
arms embracing the sky.

Chapter 1: The Girl Who Listened

Amara was different from the other children in the village. While they ran and played and shouted, Amara liked to sit quietly and listen. She listened to the birds, to the wind, and to the stories her grandmother told in the evenings.

"You have the gift of listening, Amara," her grandmother always said. "Not everyone has that."

One hot afternoon, after helping her grandmother fetch water from the stream, Amara sat beneath the great baobab tree to rest.

She leaned against its rough bark and closed her eyes. The shade was cool, and the air was still.

Then she heard something.

It was not the wind. It was not a bird. It was a deep, slow voice, like the sound of the earth itself speaking.

"Hello, little one."

Chapter 2: The Tree Speaks

Amara opened her eyes wide. She looked around. There was no one there. Only the tree.

"Who said hello?" she whispered.

"I did," said the voice. It came from above, from somewhere in the great branches. "I am the Baobab of Oke-Oye. And you are the first person to sit with me quietly enough to hear my voice in many, many years."

Amara was scared at first. But the voice was warm and kind, like her grandfather's voice.

"You can really talk?" she said.

"All trees can talk," said the baobab. "But most people are too busy and too loud to listen. You, Amara, are different. You listen."

Amara smiled. She had never felt so special.

Chapter 3: The Stories of the Baobab

The baobab told Amara many stories that afternoon. It told her about the village long ago, when there were fewer houses and more trees. It told her about the animals that used to drink from the stream and the birds that nested in its branches.

"I have watched this village grow," said the baobab. "I have seen happy times and hard times. I have seen children grow up and become grandparents. And through it all, I have stood here, giving shade and shelter."

"Do you ever get lonely?" Amara asked.

"Sometimes," said the baobab. "But then someone like you comes and sits with me, and I remember that I am not alone. The village is my family. The earth is my home. And the rain is my friend."

"What can I do for you?" Amara asked.

"Listen," said the baobab. "Just keep listening. To me, to the birds, to the wind, and to the people around you. When you listen, you understand. And when you understand, you can help."

Chapter 4: Sharing the Wisdom

Every day after that, Amara visited the baobab. She listened to its stories and shared what she learned with the other children.

"The baobab says the stream is getting smaller," she told them. "We should not throw trash near the water."

"The baobab says the birds are leaving because there are fewer trees," she told the elders. "We should plant more trees."

At first, people did not believe her. A talking tree? That was impossible!

But Amara was patient. She told the stories with such care and detail that slowly, people began to listen. And when they listened, they understood.

The village planted new trees. They cleaned the stream. They built birdhouses in the gardens. And the village of Oke-Oye became greener and happier than it had been in years.

Chapter 5: A Gift of Wisdom

One evening, as the sun set over Oke-Oye, Amara sat beneath the baobab for the last time that day.

"Thank you," she said, "for sharing your wisdom with me."

"Thank you for listening," said the baobab. "You have given an old tree a reason to keep talking."

Amara placed her hand on the bark. It felt warm and alive, like the hand of a friend.

"I will always come back," she said.

"I know," said the baobab. "And I will always be here."

Amara walked home through the golden light, her heart full of stories, her ears full of wisdom, and her mind full of the deep, deep knowledge that when you truly listen, the whole world has something to teach you.

What We Learned

- Listening is a powerful skill that many people forget to use.
- Nature has wisdom to share if we are quiet enough to hear it.
- Caring for the environment helps everyone in the community.
- One person who listens can inspire an entire village to change.

Discussion Questions

1. What sounds do you hear when you sit quietly outside?
2. How can we show respect for nature in our daily lives?
3. Why do you think people stopped listening to the baobab?

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Thank you for reading!

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